

Behaviour Management Policy

A relational, trauma-informed approach to behaviour

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE • Alternative Provision for Ages 5–25

ADOPTED POLICY

This policy has been formally adopted by L-Fit Pathways' co-directors and is in effect from the date shown below. Any section still shown in [square brackets and amber text] is organisation-specific detail that remains to be confirmed and inserted - it does not affect the rest of the policy's validity but should be completed as soon as possible.

Version: 1.0 (Adopted)

Date Adopted: 16 September 2026

Next Review Due: 16 September 2027 (or sooner following any legislative change or relevant incident)

1. Statement of Intent

L-Fit Pathways takes a relational, trauma-informed approach to behaviour. We recognise that many young people referred to us present behaviour that challenges as a result of unmet need, trauma, SEND or difficult prior experiences of education. Our approach is to understand the function of behaviour and respond with consistency, warmth and clear boundaries, rather than a punitive model.

2. Legal & Good Practice Framework

- Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026
- DfE "Behaviour in Schools" advice for headteachers and staff (non-statutory, adopted here as good practice)
- DfE guidance on the use of reasonable force
- Equality Act 2010 — reasonable adjustments for young people with SEND or disabilities
- SEND Code of Practice 2015

3. Our Approach

Staff are trained to recognise behaviour as communication. Before responding, staff consider what need the behaviour may be signalling (e.g. anxiety, sensory overload, communication difficulty, past trauma). We prioritise de-escalation, co-regulation and restorative conversation over sanction.

4. Rewards & Positive Reinforcement

Each young person's plan includes individual, meaningful positive reinforcement agreed with them and their family, recognising effort and progress rather than compliance alone.

5. Responding to Behaviour That Challenges

- De-escalation and co-regulation techniques used as first response
- A calm, low-stimulus space available for young people who need to regulate

- Individual behaviour support plans for young people with a recurring pattern of need, agreed with parents/carers and referring professionals
- Debrief and restorative conversation after any significant incident

6. Physical Intervention

Physical intervention or reasonable force is used only as an absolute last resort to prevent immediate harm, in line with our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy and DfE guidance on reasonable force. Any use is recorded, reported to a Designated Safeguarding Lead, and communicated to parents/carers the same day.

7. Ending or Pausing a Placement

L-Fit Pathways is not a registered school and does not "exclude" young people in the statutory sense. Where a young person's behaviour poses a serious risk to themselves, other young people or staff, a placement may be paused while a revised plan is agreed with the young person, their family and the referring school, college or local authority. This decision is made jointly by the Co-Directors and is never used as a first response.

8. Recording & Reporting

All significant behaviour incidents are logged, including triggers, response and outcome, and shared with parents/carers and referring professionals as appropriate.

9. Roles & Responsibilities

Adam Byrne and Craig Lloyd hold overall responsibility for this policy and for approving any individual behaviour support plan.

10. Monitoring & Review

This policy is reviewed annually, or sooner following a significant incident or change in guidance.

Policy adopted on: 16 September 2026 — Next review due: 16 September 2027